coach kris.

The Free Website Playbook

no monthly fees

yours forever

no code

under 3 hours

Websites are not magic. They are just steps.

THE SMALL PRINT

Rights, and what this playbook is

The Free Website Playbook
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weesites.co.uk · coachkris.co.uk · First edition, 2026

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Eighteen short chapters. One afternoon.

Three parts. Read them in order the first time, then keep it open as a manual.

START HERE

- About me
- You Do Not Need A Developer. You Need Under 3 Hours.

Two pages, then you are into the steps. No theory you will not use.

THE EXTRAS

- Watch The Numbers: Umami
- When It Misbehaves
- The Honest Pitch
- Twenty Questions, Answered

Analytics, fixes when it breaks, the honest pitch, and twenty questions answered.

THE TWELVE STEPS

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02 Vercel: Your Site's Landlord, Free

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HOW TO USE IT

1. Read the introduction once, then work one step at a time. They hand off to each other.
2. Playbook open on one side, browser on the other. Every numbered card is a click, not a thought.
3. Expect to stop for DNS. That wait is normal, it costs nothing, so carry on while it settles.

HELLO

About me



Hi, I'm Kris.

I've been building websites since I was 14. What started as an interest in design turned into a skill I've carried through different jobs, countries, industries and businesses.

I studied graphic design, worked in hospitality in Ireland, spent two years in the superyacht industry, and kept building websites along the way. Sometimes that meant working on them at night after a full day of managing deck tasks. I've since built my own businesses, from my coaching practice at coachkris.co.uk to Wee Sites, where I create websites for coaches, therapists and small businesses.

I haven't learned this stuff by sitting in a classroom or repeating what someone else told me works. I've learned by building things, making mistakes, figuring out what went wrong, fixing them and doing it all over again.

That's exactly why I wrote this playbook.

I want to help you build something of your own, understand what you're doing rather than blindly following instructions, and realise that you don't need to be an expert to get started. You just need the right guidance and a willingness to give it a go.

If there's one thing I've learned, it's that you don't have to know everything before you start. You learn by doing.

So, let's get building.

You can find more resources, articles and practical tools at coachkris.co.uk

INTRODUCTION

You Do Not Need A Developer. You Need Under 3 Hours.

The only clock you do not control is DNS, the internet's address playbook quietly pointing your name at your site: up to 48 hours of waiting that costs no work time.

THE HONEST TRUTH

Websites are not magic. They are just *steps*, and you can follow steps.

YOUR FIVE STATIONS

GitHub
the free folder in the cloud that stores your website.

Vercel
the free service that puts it online.

Base44
the AI agent that builds it with you, in any language you like.

Your domain
yourname.com, the only thing you pay for.

Google
where you tell the internet you exist.

WHAT BUYING THIS PLAYBOOK BUYS YOU

1. The whole method in plain words, nothing held back. Every step works on its own, so there is no upsell you need to finish your website.
2. And if you would rather someone just built it for you: that is what I do, at weesites.co.uk.

PREFER WATCHING?

Every step is also a detailed video tutorial in my Skool community. You can come build alongside me, if you like.

STEP 01

GitHub: Your Website's Home

GitHub is a free folder in the cloud. Every website is just files: pages, styles, pictures. GitHub keeps your files safe and public.

Think of it like this: your website is a document. GitHub is the drawer you keep it in. Later, Vercel reads that drawer and serves your site to the world. Every time the drawer updates, your live site updates.

DO THIS

- 1. Go to **github.com** and click Sign up. Use your normal email.
- 2. Pick a username that is short, lowercase, no spaces. This is your GitHub name forever.
- 3. Verify your email when the confirmation lands.
- 4. Click the green **New** button and create a repository. Call it **my-website**. Choose Public. Skip every other option.
- 5. Done. Your drawer exists. It is empty for now, and that is fine.

You now own a permanent, free home for your website files. Nobody can take it away or rent it back to you.

STEP 02

Vercel: Your Site's Landlord, Free

Vercel is a hosting service. Hosting just means: a computer somewhere that shows your files to visitors. Vercel does this free for simple websites.

This is the bit people expect to pay for. You do not have to. Simple websites cost Vercel almost nothing to serve, so they host them free on the Hobby plan. No card required.

DO THIS

1. Go to **vercel.com** and click Sign Up.
2. Choose **Continue with GitHub**. Yes, the one you made in Step 01. One click, no new password.
3. Approve the connection when GitHub asks.
4. You land in the Vercel dashboard. That is it. Account created, still £0.

WHY FREE IS FINE

Simple websites are *tiny* for a host like Vercel. Free is not a trick here, it is maths.

OR, IF VERCEL IS NOT YOUR FLAVOUR

Cloudflare Pages and Netlify do the same job, also free, and both happily host a business site. This playbook builds on Vercel because that is what I use, and its free Hobby plan is generous for a simple site. If your project grows into a serious business, Vercel will politely ask you to upgrade, and the other two will keep hosting you free. Your site, your choice.

STEP 03

Connect Them: The Pipe

Now you connect the drawer to the landlord. After this, every change to your files publishes itself. You will never touch this setting again.

DO THIS

1. In Vercel, click **Add New**, then **Project**.
2. Vercel lists your GitHub repositories. Find **my-website** and click **Import**.
3. Do not touch any settings. Click **Deploy**.
4. Thirty seconds later you get a live URL like **my-website.vercel.app**. It shows an empty page. Correct: your repository is empty.

Keep that .vercel.app URL. It is your real, shareable website link from this moment on. When real files land in the repository, this URL turns into your actual site, automatically.

The pipe is built. From now on: files change, site changes. No deploying by hand, ever.

STEP 04

Base44: Hire A Builder Who Speaks Zeros And Ones

Base44 gives you an AI agent. You type what you want in normal words, it answers in zeros and ones, and everybody wins. It writes the actual website files for you.

One important thing before you sign up. Base44 has two things inside it: an app-creating tool, and a plain chat with an agent. You want the **agent chat**. The app-creating tool builds apps with logins and databases. You do not want that. You want a simple, fast, honest HTML website, the kind Google loves and phones load instantly.

WANT TO GO EVEN FASTER?

The Prompt Pack at weesites.co.uk holds a ready-made prompt for every step in this playbook, plus prompts to sharpen your page titles, your meta descriptions and your copy for search engines. Prompts make your words clearer for Google and for customers; they cannot promise rankings or traffic, and nobody honest can. Optional, of course. But it is the shortcut, and I like shortcuts.

DO THIS

- 1. Go to **base44.com** and sign up.
- 2. Create an agent and open a chat with it. This chat is your workshop. You will do everything in this one conversation.
- 3. When you start your first message, say the magic words: build me a **static HTML website**. Not an app. Not a platform. HTML.

THE ONE RULE

Say *html web*, not app. Static HTML is faster, cheaper, free to host, and simpler to fix when something breaks.

STEP 05

Steal Some Taste (Legally)

A builder with no brief builds something beige. Before you brief your agent, go find three to five websites you like the look of.

These can be anyone's sites: a competitor, a bakery in another country, a portfolio you once saw and loved. You are not copying them. You are naming what you like so the agent can build you something in that spirit.

DO THIS

- 1. Open a note on your phone. Call it **Website References**.
- 2. Collect 3 to 5 links. For each one, write one line about what you like: the layout, the colours, the tone of the words, a section you want.
- 3. Also screenshot each one. Links and pictures together beat either alone.
- 4. Optional and smart: grab one site you **hate**. Say why. Negative briefs are gold.

Good example: "I like this one because it is one page, the buttons are obvious, and it feels friendly without being childish." That single sentence is worth more than a page of adjectives.

STEP 06

The Little Questionnaire

These are the same questions I ask every client I build for. Answer them in the same note, roughly, in your own words. Half an hour here saves you a week of vague revisions later.

01

Who are you and what is this site for? Your name, your work, one sentence about it.

02

Who will visit? Clients, employers, fans? What should they feel in the first five seconds?

03

What pages do you need? Home, About, Services, Contact is the classic four. Blog optional.

04

What must be on there? Services, prices, testimonials, photos, booking, your story.

05

Which reference links did you like, and why? Paste them from Step 05.

06

How should it sound? Warm and chatty, sharp and professional, playful, calm?

07

Colours you love or already use. If you have a logo, mention it.

08

How do people contact you? Email, phone, WhatsApp, a form, social links.

09

Any domain name ideas? What would you type into a business card?

Rough answers beat perfect blanks. Write it messy, fix it later.

STEP 07

Brief The Agent

Back in your Base44 chat, paste everything you collected: the questionnaire answers and the reference links with your one-line notes. Then the magic words: build me a static HTML website.

The agent will build a first version fast. It will be roughly right. That is the point: it is easier to react to something real than to describe something perfect.

HOW TO ITERATE WITHOUT LOSING YOUR MIND

- Keep everything in one chat. The agent remembers the whole conversation.
- Give feedback like a human: "the header is too tall", "make the contact button orange", "shorter sentences in the About page".
- One change at a time. Five changes in one message means five chances for confusion.
- Look at it on your phone after every big change. Most of your visitors are on phones.
- Stop when it is good, not when it is perfect. You can improve it forever, for free, later.

MINDSET

This is a conversation, not a wish. Say *what changed and what you want*, and it gets built.

STEP 08

Publish It To The World

When you are happy with the version in the chat, it is time to put the files in your GitHub drawer. Remember the pipe from Step 03: files go in, site goes live.

Your agent can push the finished files straight into your my-website repository. For that, it needs one thing from you: a GitHub key.

GIVE THE AGENT YOUR GITHUB KEY

- 1. On GitHub: Settings, Developer settings, Personal access tokens, Fine-grained tokens, Generate new token.
- 2. Under Repository access choose Only select repositories and pick my-website. Under Permissions tick Contents: Read and write. Nothing else.
- 3. Copy the token and save it somewhere safe: GitHub will not show it to you again. It is a house key, not your passport, and it opens this one repository only.
- 4. Paste it into your own private agent chat, once. Never a group or shared chat. Revoke it any time from the same GitHub page.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT, ON ITS OWN

- 1. Vercel notices the new files within seconds.
- 2. It rebuilds your site automatically.
- 3. Your **my-website.vercel.app** URL now shows your real website.
- 4. Send that link to one honest friend. If it loads on their phone in two seconds, you have won.

You now have a live website. It is free, it is fast, and nobody can switch it off for non-payment. There are no payments.

STEP 09

Let People Reach You: Formspree

A website without a contact form is a shop with a locked door. Static sites have no server of their own, so forms need a free service behind them. Formspree is the one I use on every site I build, including mine.

DO THIS

- 1. Go to **formspree.io** and create a free account. The free tier gives you 50 form submissions a month, which is plenty until you are busy.
- 2. Create a New Form, name it after your website, and confirm the email that will receive the messages.
- 3. It hands you an endpoint that looks like **formspree.io/f/abcdnwq**. That little address is your letterbox.
- 4. Paste it into your agent chat and say: wire my contact form to this endpoint, submit without leaving the page, and show a success message.
- 5. Test it yourself: fill your own form on your phone, and check the inbox you signed up with.

INSIDER TIP

Tell the agent the success message must live *outside the form*. If it sits inside, it disappears the moment the form is hidden.

STEP 10

Buy Your Name: yourname.com

The .vercel.app link works, but you did not do all this building to hand out a link that belongs to a landlord. A custom domain costs about £6 a year on Namecheap. It is the only money in this whole playbook.

HOW TO PICK A GOOD NAME

Say it out loud. If you have to spell it after saying it, it is wrong.

Short beats clever. Two or three words maximum.

.com first, .co.uk if you are UK-based, then the rest.

No hyphens, no numbers, no "thebestwebsitedesignltd".

Your own name is a completely fine domain if it is available. You are the brand.

DO THIS

- 1. Easiest route: buy the domain inside Vercel. Vercel, Project, Settings, Domains, Buy. One place, no fiddling later.
- 2. Or buy at a registrar like Namecheap and point it at Vercel in the next step. Same result, one extra step.

REMEMBER

Own the name. Renting your own address from a platform is how people end up *stuck*.

STEP 11

Point Your Name At Your Site

A domain is a signpost. Right now it points at nothing. This step makes it point at your Vercel site. Ten minutes, one time, never again.

IF YOU BOUGHT IN VERCEL

Vercel connects it for you the moment you click Add. Skip ahead to the Check yourself. That is the reward for buying it there.

IF YOU BOUGHT ELSEWHERE

1. In Vercel: Project, Settings, **Domains**, Add, type your domain.
2. Vercel shows you DNS records: usually an A record and a CNAME. Copy them exactly.
3. At your registrar, find DNS settings for the domain and paste the records in.
4. Wait. DNS takes minutes to 48 hours. This is normal, and nothing is broken.
5. Vercel shows a green tick and issues your HTTPS padlock automatically. Free, and it matters.

Type it on a business card. That line is yours now.

STEP 12

Get On Google

Google will find your site eventually, but "eventually" is a long time when it is your business. You can knock on the door yourself, for free, with Google Search Console.

DO THIS

- 1. Go to **search.google.com/search-console** and sign in with a Google account.
- 2. Add your domain as a property. Google asks you to prove it is yours with a DNS record. Paste it at your registrar like Step 11.
- 3. Ask your agent for a **sitemap.xml** if you do not have one. A sitemap is a simple list of your pages, and a good agent makes one automatically.
- 4. In Search Console, find Sitemaps, submit **sitemap.xml**.
- 5. Use the URL Inspection tool on your homepage and press **Request Indexing**.

BE PATIENT

Google works on its own clock: days, sometimes weeks. You have knocked on the door. That is *all you can do*, and it is enough.

From zero to on Google, for the price of a domain. Everything else in this playbook was free.

BONUS

Watch The Numbers: Umami

Your site is live. Now the fun bit: seeing who visits. Umami is free, cookie-free analytics. No consent banners, nothing creepy, nothing to configure for GDPR.

DO THIS

- 1. Go to **umami.is** and create a free cloud account.
- 2. Add your website. Umami hands you a small tracking snippet.
- 3. Paste the snippet into your agent chat and say: add this to every page, and make it deferred. One message, done.
- 4. Open your Umami dashboard: visits, pages, referrers, countries. All there, in plain numbers.

WHY UMAMI

No cookies, no consent banner, no tracking industry. Just a counter that *respects people*.

Check it weekly, not hourly. Analytics is a compass, not a scoreboard.

APPENDIX

When It Misbehaves

DEPLOY ERROR

Nine times out of ten, a file name or a missing bracket. Paste the error back into your agent chat and say fix this. This is what it is for.

DOMAIN NOT WORKING

DNS takes up to 48 hours. If it still fails after that, check the records match Vercel's instructions letter by letter.

NOT ON GOOGLE

Check your robots.txt is not blocking anyone, your sitemap is submitted, and give it a week before panicking. Ask the agent to check all three.

CONTACT FORM SILENT

You wired Formspree in Step 09. Resend a test from your phone, check the spam folder, and ask the agent to confirm the endpoint is in the form.

BEFORE YOU GO

The honest pitch

Some people genuinely enjoy this process. If that is you, brilliant: go build, and the only money you spend is your domain.

And some people read this whole playbook and feel tired. That is also useful information.

Build it yourself

You already own this playbook: twelve steps, one afternoon, and a domain. Nothing monthly, nothing rented, and every file ends up yours.

Start at Step 01.

Have it built for you

If you would rather someone just built it, that is what I do at weesites.co.uk: custom-coded, no monthly fees, and you own every file. No hard feelings either way. The website exists either way.

weesites.co.uk

Or build it alongside me

Join the community, watch the tutorials, and build it alongside me. Everything in this playbook stands on its own; the extras are just company.

ONE LAST HONEST NOTE

The third-party services in this playbook, including their terms, pricing and free-plan limits, can change at any time. The instructions here reflect the method and information available when this playbook was prepared. Before launching your website, check each provider's current terms to make sure your intended use is permitted. What will not change: your website is yours, and hosting and editing it stays free of monthly charges.

Questions? I read everything. **hello.coachkris@gmail.com**

FAQ

Twenty Questions, Answered

The questions I hear most, answered the way I'd answer them across the table. Short, honest, no jargon.

Do I need to know how to code?

No. That is the whole point. The guide tells you exactly what to click at every step, and the AI agent handles the technical plumbing behind the curtain. You point, you paste, you publish.

Is the website really free?

The hosting is free, permanently. GitHub and Vercel charge nothing for a site like this. The only thing you pay for is your domain, about £6 a year. That is the entire bill.

How long will it actually take?

Under three hours, and most of it is pleasantly boring. You will spend longer choosing your words than wrestling with tools, which is exactly how it should be.

What does the playbook cover?

Twelve steps: setting up your site's home, putting it online, your domain, contact forms, analytics, and getting found on Google. Plus a bonus chapter and a rescue chapter for when something misbehaves.

What if I already pay for Wix or Squarespace?

Yes. Take your current website on Wix or any other platform, give it to your agent in Base44, and ask it to closely rebuild it as a working HTML version, a 1:1 copy or as close as possible. Then cancel the subscription and stop paying rent.

Will my site look like a template?

No. There are no templates here. Your words, your colours, your layout. The only person it looks like is you.

Do I actually own the website?

Yes. Every file, every account, every line. Nobody can switch it off, stamp their logo on it, or raise the price on you, because there is no price.

What are the monthly fees?

None. That is not a marketing line, it is the architecture. Free hosting, a £6 domain, done.

Can I use the domain I already own?

Yes. The guide shows you how to point it at your new site. It takes about five minutes and feels suspiciously easy.

Will it work on phones?

Yes, properly, not the technically-it-fits kind. The guide builds for the phone first, because that is where your clients are looking at you.

Will Google find me?

The final step submits your site to Google and covers the basics that actually matter. You will not outrank a national chain on day one, but people searching your name and your town will find you.

Can I add a contact form?

Yes, there is a full step on it using Formspree: free, no code, and the messages land straight in your inbox. Web3Forms and FormSubmit are two other free options that do the same job. No carrier pigeons required.

Can I sell things on the site?

You can take bookings and payments with simple free tools. If you need a full shop with stock levels and shipping labels, that is a different project, and I will say so honestly rather than pretend otherwise.

What do I need before I start?

A laptop, an internet connection, and three hours. If you can use email, you already have every required skill.

What if I get stuck?

Re-read the step, then read the rescue chapter. Still stuck? Join the Skool group and build it alongside me, or playbook a Make It With Me call with me at coachkris.co.uk. You are not expected to suffer in silence.

Who is this playbook for?

Hobbyists and side-project builders first, plus freelancers, coaches and small business owners. Anyone who wants their own corner of the internet without paying monthly rent for it.

Who is it not for?

If you want an online store with a warehouse behind it, or a social network, or logins for thousands of users, this is not your playbook. Wrong tool, no shame.

Why is the playbook so cheap?

Because the information is simple and the tools are free. £17 buys you the shortcut, not the secret. There is no secret.

Will the steps go out of date?

Buttons move around, the ideas do not. If a step changes badly, updated details go up on coachkris.co.uk so you are never following a dead path.

What if I read it and decide I'd rather pay someone?

Then the playbook did its job. I build these for a living at weesites.co.uk, no monthly fees, and you own every file. Try it yourself first. You now know exactly how the machine works.

WHERE TO FIND ME

You built it. Now go and be found.

If anything in here saved you a subscription, a stranger's invoice, or a week of your life, tell one person who is still paying rent on a template. That is the whole marketing budget.

BUILD WITH ME

Custom websites for coaches, therapists and small businesses. No monthly fees, you own every file.

weesites.co.uk

COACHING

Life, longevity and business coaching. Break the loop, then build something you keep.

coachkris.co.uk

BUILD ALONGSIDE ME

Video walkthroughs of every step in this playbook, plus the Prompt Pack.

weesites.co.uk/playbook

SAY HELLO

Questions, screenshots of what broke, or a site you want me to look at. I read all of it.

hello.coachkris@gmail.com